

simpleDocs

Installation and user guide for the Windows contextual AI assistant.

How to install

- 1 Download the ZIP, choose Extract All, and open the extracted folder. Do not run the installer from inside the ZIP preview.
- 2 Keep all six files together, then double-click Install-simpleDocs.cmd. No administrator access, account, login, or redeem code is required.
- 3 Wait for the successful installation message. The app is copied to your Windows user profile and then opens in the system tray.
- 4 Confirm the simpleDocs tray icon is visible. You can also search for simpleDocs in the Windows Start Menu.
- 5 Select code or technical text and press Ctrl+Shift+Space. If the popup appears, installation is complete.

Why the installation files are required

appsettings.json provides the public production service address and no-login setting. Install-simpleDocs.cmd is the file users can safely double-click. Install-simpleDocs.ps1 copies the app to a stable location, creates the Start Menu shortcut, registers automatic startup, and upgrades older versions. Keep these files beside CodeExplainer.exe while installing.

Daily use

Select the smallest complete code block, error, terminal message, equation, or technical passage that represents your question. For browser equations, select the formula rather than surrounding page controls. Press Ctrl+Shift+Space once and read the explanation in the popup.

Startup and updates

simpleDocs starts automatically after you sign in to Windows. Use Start On Windows Login in the tray menu to change this. When a newer ZIP is provided, extract it and run Install-simpleDocs.cmd again; the installer safely replaces the older installed version and repairs startup integration.

If it does not work

Confirm that the tray icon is visible and the internet connection works. Select the text again and press the hotkey once. If simpleDocs does not start after sign-in, open it from the Start Menu and check Start On Windows Login. Rerun the latest installer if files or startup registration are missing.

Privacy

Selected text and limited nearby context are sent to the hosted service to generate an explanation. Do not select passwords, API keys, authentication tokens, personal records, or confidential information.

Our research

simpleDocs grew from our presented paper, An OS-Level Contextual AI Assistant for Reducing Context Switching in Novice Programming Workflows. The research explores helping novice programmers stay focused while reading code, learning, and debugging.

Thank you for using our tool

Your feedback helps improve simpleDocs and continue this research. Kindly connect with me on LinkedIn and share what worked well or what could be better.

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